

D379

Social Media Marketing

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A bakery's Instagram post reached 8,000 accounts and got 240 likes, 40 comments, and 40 shares. The bakery has 20,000 followers and posted at 7 a.m. What is the engagement rate by reach?

- A. 4%
- B. 1.6%
- C. 25
- D. 3%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A brand wants a 5% engagement rate by reach on a post expected to reach 12,000 accounts. How many engagements does it need?

- A. 2,400
- B. 600
- C. 5
- D. 60

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A company sells \$50,000 cybersecurity software to IT directors at mid-size firms. Its young social team loves making short dance videos, and its office has a rooftop garden. Which platform should lead its social strategy?

- A. LinkedIn
- B. Every platform equally, since the audience is everywhere
- C. Pinterest
- D. A short-video app built around dance trends

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A candle shop has 15,000 Facebook followers, but each post reaches only about 800 people. The owner just hired a part-time photographer. What explains the low reach, and what reaches a chosen audience fastest?

- A. Posting several more times a day will always restore full reach.
- B. Buy more followers so each post reaches more people.
- C. The algorithm limits organic reach; paid promotion with targeting reaches a chosen audience quickly.
- D. Better photos from the new hire will fix reach on their own.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A skincare brand is choosing between a celebrity with 5 million followers, 0.4% engagement, and a mostly gaming audience, and a skincare creator with 40,000 followers, 6% engagement, and a mostly skincare audience. The celebrity recently launched a clothing line. Which choice is best?

- A. The celebrity, because 5 million followers means the biggest reach.
- B. The skincare creator, with no disclosure needed if the product is gifted.
- C. The celebrity, because the clothing line shows business sense.
- D. The skincare creator, with every sponsored post clearly disclosed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An influencer receives free headphones from a brand and posts a glowing review without mentioning the gift. What is the problem?

- A. There is no problem, since no money changed hands.
- B. The post fails to disclose a material connection, which endorsement rules require.
- C. Only the brand is ever responsible, never the influencer.
- D. It is a problem only for influencers with over 100,000 followers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A hospital system wants more people to see its nurse-recruiting posts. Its official page has 30,000 followers, and 2,000 employees have personal accounts. The marketing chief prefers a purple color scheme. Which approach is employee advocacy done right?

- A. Offer employees approved, easy-to-share posts and guidelines; participation is voluntary and they note they work there.
- B. Switch the page to the purple color scheme.
- C. Have employees post as unaffiliated patients praising the hospital.
- D. Require every employee to share daily or face a performance review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A sales rep for a logistics firm connects on LinkedIn with a warehouse manager who recently posted about late shipments. The rep's company recently moved its headquarters. What is the best social-selling move?

- A. Send the same pitch to all 500 connections at once.
- B. Immediately send a pricing sheet by direct message.
- C. Tell the manager about the headquarters move.
- D. Comment with a useful tip on reducing late shipments and share a relevant resource.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A snack brand wants to learn what people say about healthy late-night snacks in general, not just posts that tag the brand, to find new product ideas. Its CEO recently spoke at a food-industry conference. Which activity fits?

- A. Tracking mentions of the CEO's conference talk
- B. Social monitoring of the brand's @mentions
- C. Social listening on topic keywords and sentiment
- D. Replying to every comment within an hour

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A brand's team tracks and replies to every post that tags its handle about late orders. Which activity is this?

- A.** Influencer marketing
- B.** Social listening
- C.** Social monitoring
- D.** Social selling

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An online furniture store wants to reach people who added a sofa to their cart in the last 14 days but did not buy. The store also sponsors a home-design podcast. Which targeting option fits?

- A.** Demographic targeting of adults aged 25 to 54
- B.** A retargeting custom audience of recent cart abandoners
- C.** Interest targeting of home-design podcast fans
- D.** A lookalike audience

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A brand uploads a list of its best customers to find new people who resemble them. Which audience type is this?

- A.** A custom audience, which always finds new customers
- B.** Retargeting custom audience
- C.** Demographic audience
- D.** Lookalike audience

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A bakery's Instagram post reached 8,000 accounts and got 240 likes, 40 comments, and 40 shares. ~~The bakery has 20,000 followers and posted at 7 a.m.~~ What is the engagement rate by reach?

Target word: engagement rate by reach **Decides:** 320 total engagements / 8,000 reach.

A	Correct	$(240 + 40 + 40) / 8,000 = 0.04$.
B	Camouflage	Divides by the 20,000 followers, not reach.
C	Inverted operation	$8,000 / 320$ divides the wrong way.
D	Dropped element	Counts likes only: $240 / 8,000$.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A brand wants a 5% engagement rate by reach on a post expected to reach 12,000 accounts. How many engagements does it need?

Target word: solve for engagements **Decides:** $12,000 \times 0.05$.

A	Inverted operation	$12,000 / 5$ divides instead of taking a percentage.
B	Correct	$12,000 \times 5\% = 600$.
C	Wrong stem number	The target percentage, not a count.
D	Dropped element	Uses 0.005, dropping a decimal place.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A company sells \$50,000 cybersecurity software to IT directors at mid-size firms. Its young social team loves making short dance videos, ~~and its office has a rooftop garden.~~ Which platform should lead its social strategy?

Target word: best platform **Decides:** B2B IT decision-makers.

A	Correct	Where professional B2B buyers research and network.
B	Absolute language	Spreads effort thin and ignores audience fit.
C	Confusion set	A visual-inspiration platform with little B2B software buying.
D	Camouflage	Follows the team's taste, not the buyer's.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A candle shop has 15,000 Facebook followers, but each post reaches only about 800 people. ~~The owner just hired a part-time photographer.~~ What explains the low reach, and what reaches a chosen audience fastest?

Target word: cause and fix for low reach **Decides:** Organic reach is limited by the algorithm.

A	Absolute language	Frequency does not guarantee reach and can lower engagement.
B	Adjacent category	Follower count is not reach; bought followers do not engage.
C	Correct	Organic reach is a small share of followers; paid reach is bought and targeted.
D	Camouflage	Better creative helps a little but does not remove the organic limit.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A skincare brand is choosing between a celebrity with 5 million followers, 0.4% engagement, and a mostly gaming audience, and a skincare creator with 40,000 followers, 6% engagement, and a mostly skincare audience. ~~The celebrity recently launched a clothing line.~~ Which choice is best?

Target word: influencer choice **Decides:** Audience relevance and engagement.

A	Dropped element	Drops audience relevance; gamers are not the target.
B	Confusion set	Gifted products are a material connection that must be disclosed.
C	Camouflage	Answers the clothing-line detail, which does not decide fit.
D	Correct	Relevant audience and strong engagement, with required disclosure.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

An influencer receives free headphones from a brand and posts a glowing review without mentioning the gift. What is the problem?

Target word: reverse: from post to rule **Decides:** A gift is a material connection.

A	Dropped element	Drops the gift; free products count.
B	Correct	Free products must be clearly disclosed.
C	Absolute language	Both the brand and the influencer have duties.
D	Adjacent category	Disclosure duties do not depend on follower count.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A hospital system wants more people to see its nurse-recruiting posts. Its official page has 30,000 followers, and 2,000 employees have personal accounts. ~~The marketing chief prefers a purple color scheme.~~ Which approach is employee advocacy done right?

Target word: correct advocacy program **Decides:** Voluntary, easy, approved, disclosed sharing.

A	Correct	Authentic, guided, and transparent advocacy.
B	Camouflage	Design preference does not create advocacy.
C	Adjacent category	That is deceptive astroturfing, not advocacy.
D	Absolute language	Forced sharing is inauthentic and harms trust.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A sales rep for a logistics firm connects on LinkedIn with a warehouse manager who recently posted about late shipments. ~~The rep's company recently moved its headquarters.~~ What is the best social-selling move?

Target word: best first move **Decides:** Build the relationship with useful insight first.

A	Adjacent category	Mass outreach is spam, not social selling.
B	Inverted operation	Pitches before a relationship exists.
C	Camouflage	Irrelevant to the prospect's problem.
D	Correct	Adds value and builds trust before any pitch.

9. Answer C Concept 7

A snack brand wants to learn what people say about healthy late-night snacks in general, not just posts that tag the brand, to find new product ideas. ~~Its CEO recently spoke at a food industry conference.~~ Which activity fits?

Target word: activity type **Decides:** Broad conversation for insight, not tagged mentions.

A	Camouflage	Answers the conference detail, not the product question.
B	Confusion set	Monitoring covers only direct mentions.
C	Correct	Listening studies broad conversation for insight.
D	Adjacent category	That is customer care, not insight research.

10. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A brand's team tracks and replies to every post that tags its handle about late orders. Which activity is this?

Target word: reverse: from activity to name **Decides:** Responding to direct tags.

A	Confusion set	Partnering with creators, unrelated here.
B	Inverted operation	Listening analyzes wider conversation for insight.
C	Correct	Tracking and responding to direct mentions.
D	Adjacent category	Relationship building with prospects, not service replies.

11. Answer B Concept 8

An online furniture store wants to reach people who added a sofa to their cart in the last 14 days but did not buy. ~~The store also sponsors a home design podcast.~~ Which targeting option fits?

Target word: targeting type **Decides:** People who already interacted with the site.

A	Adjacent category	Broad traits, not the specific cart abandoners.
B	Correct	Reaches the exact people who already showed intent.
C	Camouflage	Answers the podcast detail, not the abandoners.
D	Confusion set	Finds new people similar to a source list, not the same people.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

A brand uploads a list of its best customers to find new people who resemble them. Which audience type is this?

Target word: reverse: from goal to audience type **Decides:** Finding new, similar people.

A	Absolute language	Custom audiences target existing contacts.
B	Inverted operation	Reaches the same people, not new ones.
C	Adjacent category	Built from traits, not a customer list.
D	Correct	Built from a source list to find similar new people.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Engagement rate	Engagement rate by reach = total engagements (likes, comments, shares, saves) / reach.	Counting only likes, or dividing by followers when reach is asked.	Reach, follower count, and several engagement types in one stem.
2	Platform-audience fit	Choose platforms where the target audience actually spends time and makes the relevant decision.	Choosing the platform the team personally likes or that is trending.	A clearly defined buyer (e.g., B2B decision-makers) plus a list of platforms.
3	Organic vs. paid social reach	Algorithms show organic posts to a small share of followers; paid promotion buys targeted reach.	Believing more followers or more posts restores full organic reach.	Large follower count, small reach per post.
4	Influencer fit and disclosure	Pick influencers for audience relevance and engagement, not raw follower count, and require clear disclosure of any paid or gifted relationship.	Choosing the biggest name, or thinking free products need no disclosure.	Two creators with different sizes, engagement, and audiences; or a gifted product.
5	Employee advocacy	Give employees easy, approved, shareable content and clear guidelines; participation is voluntary and employment is disclosed.	Forcing posts or having employees pose as unaffiliated customers.	“Get employees to share” in the stem.
6	Social selling	Social selling builds relationships by listening and offering useful insight before any pitch.	Opening with a sales pitch or mass messages.	A salesperson connecting with a prospect on a social network.
7	Social listening vs. monitoring	Monitoring tracks and responds to direct brand mentions; listening analyzes wider conversations and sentiment for insight.	Calling reply-to-mentions work “listening.”	Whether the goal is responding to tags or learning from broad conversation.
8	Ad audience targeting types	Retargeting (custom audiences) reaches people who already interacted with you; lookalikes find new people similar to them; demographic and interest targeting use traits.	Using a lookalike to reach past visitors, or retargeting to find new people.	Whether the people have already interacted with the brand.

Course scope (public description): Social Media Marketing teaches learners about social media from a business perspective and how social media can be used to increase a company’s brand awareness, generate leads, and build meaningful relationships with customers. Throughout this course, learners will develop a social media marketing strategy across various social platforms to create and distribute valuable and relevant content to specific audiences. Social Media Marketing teaches learners influencer marketing, employee advocacy, social selling, and social media analytics. Learners will gain hands-on experience using a simulation to create targeted social media advertisements, perform demographic targeting, implement social media content promotion strategies, and schedule content. In this course, learners will have the opportunity to complete HubSpot’s Social Media Marketing certification to learn industry best practices in social media marketing and to enhance marketability within the marketing profession.